

Keyword matrix / gap analysis

List what the job description actually asks for, then be honest about the match. A named gap in a cover letter reads as self-aware. A hidden one reads as a lie once you're in the room.

JD REQUIREMENT	YOUR MATCH	GAP	HOW IT'S HANDLED
BS Engineering/Construction Mgmt./technical field	BA Journalism & PR	Real, hard gap	Listed as-is in Education; named directly in cover letter's honest-gap paragraph
Last 4 companies O&G, midstream pipelines focus	GM/Manager/Project Manager/Director of ops, terminal/pipeline, offshore oil platform projects	None	Leads the summary
\$100M–1B+ capital programs	\$50M+ portfolio is your real ceiling	Real, confirmed gap	Named plainly in cover letter, not papered over
Project Director / Program Director title history	Highest titles: Director of operations, General Manager, Manager	Real gap	Framed by scope of ownership (P&L, portfolio, team) rather than title label
EPCM delivery model	Not documented	Real gap	Not claimed anywhere
Compressor stations	Not confirmed	Real gap	Not claimed
PHMSA/FERC regulatory approvals	PHMSA audit work, deep (49 CFR 195 cert, 207 jurisdictions, passed federal audit). FERC: general regulatory training at last position	Partial	PHMSA led with, FERC stated honestly as training, not expertise
PE/PMP	Neither	Real gap (preferred only)	Omitted
Pipeline construction/lifecycle execution	Strong: 1040-mi BTC pipeline construction and management, 40 mile/150K bbl/day pipeline + terminal commission, 40,000 ft gas line	None	Led with in summary and bullets
Digital project delivery/analytics	Power BI, ArcGIS, Planisware, SCADA, AI workflows	None	Framed as decision mechanism, not a skills list

Blank version: copy this layout for your next target role. Four columns, one row per requirement, no gap left unaddressed.